A Rugged Legacy

India's official nomination for UNESCO's World Heritage Sites list for 2024-25 is the 'Maratha Military Landscapes of India'. The Marathas developed a complex fortification system between the 17th and 19th centuries. There are nearly 400 of these forts in Maharashtra today, of which 11—Salher Fort, Shivneri Fort, Lohgad, Khanderi Fort, Raigad, Rajgad (*in picture*), Pratapgad, Suvarnadurg, Panhala Fort, Vijaydurg and Sindhudurg—besides one from Tamil Nadu (Gingee Fort) are part of the nomination. Distributed across a diverse geography, some like Salher Fort and Lohgad are hill forts, Vijaydurg is a coastal fort, and Suvarnadurg and Sindhudurg are island forts. True to their terroir, these majestic sentinels from the past blend seamlessly with their setting.



SHUTTERSTOCK